



THE STILLWATER LETTERS

21 Days of Returning

a gentle prayer journal

“Return to me, and I will return to you.” — Zechariah 1:3



Before you begin

Welcome, friend. I am so glad you are here.

For the next 21 days, this little journal is a quiet place to return — not to do more, but to come home. There is nothing to achieve here, and no way to fall behind. Each day holds a single word, a verse to sit with, a few honest sentences, and room to write whatever rises. Start wherever you are.

However you come — weary, distracted, full of doubt, or simply curious — you are welcome. God is not waiting for a better version of you. He is here now, gentle and near.

How to use it: find a few unhurried minutes. Read the verse slowly, more than once. Let the reflection meet you where you are. Then write — honestly, imperfectly — whatever the question stirs. End with the little prayer, and make it your own. That's all. There is no behind.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Return to me, and I will return to you,” says the Lord.

ZECHARIAH 1:3

It is easy to drift — not in big, dramatic ways, but in the slow pull of busy days and tired hearts. The wonder of God is that He never asks you to earn your way back. He simply says: turn around. The smallest step toward Him is met by the whole of Him coming toward you.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Where have you drifted lately — and what would one small step back toward God look like today?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Father, I turn my face toward You again. Thank You that even now, You are already coming to meet me.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Be still, and know that I am God.”

PSALM 46:10

Stillness can feel like wasted time in a world that prizes doing. But to be still is not to do nothing — it is to stop striving long enough to remember who holds it all. You are not the one keeping the world turning. He is.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What would you have to set down — even for five minutes — to simply be still with God today?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Lord, quiet the noise in me. Help me be still long enough to remember that You are God, and I am held.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest.”

MATTHEW 11:28

Jesus doesn't wait for you to have it all together. He calls the weary ones — the ones carrying more than they can name. Rest here is not a reward for finishing; it is a gift for the tired.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What weariness are you carrying right now? Name it honestly, and picture laying it into His hands.

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Jesus, I come as I am — tired, and not finished. Thank You that Your rest is for me, today.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding.”

PROVERBS 3:5-6

Trust is hardest when we cannot see the path. But God doesn't ask you to understand everything — only to lean. And leaning means you no longer have to hold your own weight.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What are you trying to figure out on your own? What might it look like to lean, instead of solve?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Father, I don't understand all of this, and I don't have to. I choose to lean my whole weight on You.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Commit your way to the Lord; trust in him, and he will act.”

PSALM 37:5

We hold things tightly because we are afraid of what happens if we let go. But surrender is not giving up — it is handing over. There is a deep rest in open hands.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What is one thing you have been gripping tightly? Can you offer it to God, with open hands, today?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Lord, I open my hands. I give You what I have been carrying. I trust You to hold what I cannot.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness.”

2 CORINTHIANS 12:9

You do not have to be strong for God to work. In fact, He often does His deepest work in the very places you feel weakest. Your weakness is not a barrier to Him — it is an invitation.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Where do you feel weak, or ‘not enough’ right now? How might God want to meet you there with grace?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Father, where I am weak, be my strength. Thank You that Your grace is enough — even here.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us.”

1 JOHN 1:9

Shame whispers that you must hide. Grace says you can come into the light. Confession is not grovelling — it is coming home to a Father who is already running toward you.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Is there something you have been carrying that you can bring honestly to God today? Write it, and receive His forgiveness.

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Lord, I bring this into the light. Thank You for forgiving me, and for loving me through it.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“May the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace as you trust in him.”

ROMANS 15:13

Hope is not wishful thinking — it is confidence in the character of God. When the future feels uncertain, hope holds on to the One who already holds the future.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What are you hoping for? Write it out as a prayer, and place it gently in God's hands.

A WHISPERED PRAYER

God of hope, fill the empty places in me with Your peace. I trust You with what lies ahead.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Those who hope in the Lord will renew their strength.”

ISAIAH 40:31

There are seasons when you run on empty. God's strength is not a pep talk — it is renewal that comes from waiting on Him, from being near. Not from trying harder, but from drawing close.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Where do you most need renewed strength this week? What would 'waiting on the Lord' look like for you?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Lord, I am tired. Renew my strength as I wait on You. Carry me where I cannot walk.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Peace I leave with you; my peace I give you. Do not let your hearts be troubled.”

JOHN 14:27

The world's peace depends on everything going right. God's peace holds even when it doesn't. It is a gift He gives — not a feeling you have to manufacture.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What is stealing your peace right now? What would it mean to hand it over and receive His instead?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Jesus, I receive Your peace — the kind the world cannot give or take. Settle my troubled heart.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“My God will meet all your needs according to the riches of his glory.”

PHILIPPIANS 4:19

Worry counts what is missing. Faith remembers what God has already provided. He has carried you this far — and He is not about to stop now.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Where have you seen God provide, even in small ways? Where do you need to trust Him for provision now?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Father, thank You for how You have provided. I trust You with what I still need.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“We are God’s handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works.”

EPHESIANS 2:10

You are not an accident or an afterthought. You are God’s handiwork — made on purpose, loved before you did a single thing. Your worth was settled long before today.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What truth about who you are in God do you most need to remember today?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Lord, thank You that I am Yours — made on purpose, loved without condition. Help me live like I believe it.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Be strong and courageous. Do not be afraid; the Lord your God will be with you.”

JOSHUA 1:9

Courage is not the absence of fear — it is moving forward with God in the middle of it. You are never asked to go alone; His presence goes with you into every room you dread.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What is God gently asking you to step toward, even afraid? What is one small, brave step?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Father, give me courage for what is in front of me. I am not alone — You go with me. That is enough.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Give thanks in all circumstances, for this is God’s will for you.”

1 THESSALONIANS 5:18

Gratitude does not pretend everything is fine. It chooses to notice grace even in hard places. Thankfulness re-tunes the heart to see how near God really is.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Write down three small things you are thankful for today — and thank God for each one.

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Thank You, Lord — for the gifts I so easily overlook. Open my eyes to Your goodness in the ordinary.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Create in me a clean heart, O God, and renew a right spirit within me.”

PSALM 51:10

You cannot make yourself new by trying harder. Only God can do the deep work of renewal — and He delights to do it. Your part is simply to ask, and to let Him.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What part of your heart are you asking God to make new? Where do you long for a fresh start?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Father, I cannot change myself, but You can. Create in me a clean heart. Make me new.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“...and after the fire came a gentle whisper.”

1 KINGS 19:12

We often listen for God in the dramatic and miss Him in the quiet. He so often speaks in a whisper — which means we have to slow down, and lean in, to hear Him.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Sit quietly for a few minutes. What might God be gently saying to you beneath the noise of the day?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Lord, quiet me enough to hear Your whisper. Speak — and help me to listen.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see.”

HEBREWS 11:1

Faith is not certainty about outcomes — it is trust in a Person. It holds on to God's character when His ways are hidden, believing He is good even when you cannot see what He is doing.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Where are you being invited to walk by faith and not by sight right now?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Father, where I cannot see, I will trust who You are. Strengthen my faith to keep walking.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“The Lord is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit.”

PSALM 34:18

God does not stand at a distance from your pain. He draws near to the brokenhearted — not to fix you quickly, but to be with you tenderly. You are not alone in it.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Where does your heart feel tender or heavy? Bring it to the One who is already near.

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Lord, You are close to the brokenhearted. Draw near to me here. Hold what I am carrying.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“In your presence there is fullness of joy.”

PSALM 16:11

Joy is not the same as everything going well. It is a deep gladness that flows from being near to God. His presence is the well that does not run dry, even on hard days.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

What has brought you genuine joy lately? Thank God for it — and notice where He was in it.

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Father, thank You for the gift of joy in Your presence. Fill me again from the well that never runs dry.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“We love because he first loved us.”

1 JOHN 4:19

You do not have to earn God's love, and you could not lose it if you tried. Before you reach for Him, He has already reached for you. Everything begins here: you are loved first.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

How might you simply receive God's love today — before trying to do anything to deserve it?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Lord, help me rest in being loved first. Let Your love be the ground I stand on today.

TODAY'S SCRIPTURE

“The Lord is my shepherd... he leads me beside still waters.”

PSALM 23:1-2

Look back over these days. Wherever you have been — faithful or scattered, full or barely holding on — you turned your heart toward Him, and He was there. The journey does not end here; it simply continues, one quiet day at a time, led beside still waters.

SIT WITH THIS & WRITE

Look back over these 21 days. Where have you seen God meet you? What do you want to carry forward?

A WHISPERED PRAYER

Shepherd of my heart, thank You for leading me. Keep me close as I walk on. I am Yours.



You came back.

However these days have gone — full or scattered, faithful or barely — you turned your heart toward Him, and that is everything. He was never far. He never is.

This is not the end of anything, only a continuing. May you keep returning to the still waters, one quiet day at a time. And if you'd like a gentle word each week to walk with you, the Tuesday letters are waiting whenever you are.

“He leads me beside still waters.” — Psalm 23:2

With you on the way,

Alice · The Stillwater Letters